START HERE · NEAR PRIVATE AI HACKATHON NYC

SCAN THE HACKPACK

AS SOON AS YOU CAN

Do steps 1–4 on the site:

1 Check in · 2 Join the WhatsApp
3 Create a wallet · 4 Claim AI credits

WI-FI **innside** · no password



buildcity.github.io/build-city-hackpack

BUILD CITY × NEAR

[WED 11.11.26] · THE WILSON, 132 W 27TH ST

NEAR PRIVATE AI HACKATHON NYC

Build City × NEAR Legion NYC City Node · 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM ET

WI-FI **innside** · no password

WELCOME TO BUILD CITY

WHO WE ARE

An NYC builder community

Build City are the stewards of the NEAR Legion New York City Node.

TODAY

One day of building private AI

A local build day inside the global NEAR Hackathon, on NEAR AI Cloud.

YOUR HOST

Tony Singh

Ask me anything, any time today.

02 / THE BUILDERS CAFE COMMUNITY

JOIN THE BUILDERS CAFE

Builders Café: a series of events we host at local cafés across the city, every week.

They tend to be **research-based**. The events and the WhatsApp group are one of the best ways to keep up.

The **BUILD CITY HACKPACK** is pinned in the Builders Cafe WhatsApp: setup videos, prompts, the ICM guide and how to submit.

WHATSAPP + HACKPACK

03 / TODAY

THE DAY AT A GLANCE

9:00	Registration, check-in & breakfast
9:45	Welcome & introduction
9:55	NEAR AI Cloud quick start & the day’s rules
10:10	Technical talks (four, 20 minutes each)
11:30	Idea worksheet, mixer, then build
1:00	Lunch & networking
1:30	Building & mentorship · demo sign-up 2:30–4:00
4:30	Project demos & showcase
5:30	Closing & networking

NYC IS DAY 11 OF 14

$250K
prize pool, paid in NEAR

13
tracks · Track 3 is Privacy & Private AI

Nov 14
final deadline, 6:59 PM ET

Today is a local build day. You submit your project to the **global** NEAR Hackathon, and you keep three days after today to finish it.

No judging today. The 4:30 demos are a showcase. One project can fit several tracks and is still one submission.

Source: nearhackathon.com

SIX OPTIONAL DIRECTIONS

Healthcare & Personal Data	**Finance & Legal**	**AI Agents**
Agentic Commerce	**Community & Nonprofits**	**Business Automation**

Optional: these are ideas to get you started, not requirements. **Build anything you like.**

Teams of up to 4; solo builders welcome. The NEAR AI team's security & investigations use cases are in the hackpack.

SECTION 02 · 9:55–10:10

NEAR AI CLOUD QUICK START

Four steps to private inference, then how today works.

STEP 1 OF 4 · CHECK IN

REGISTER ON THE CITY NODE APP

Scan the QR with your phone camera, or open **citynode.app/onboard**.

This is how you sign up for today through the NEAR Legion City Node app.



CITY NODE APP

STEP 2 OF 4 · WALLET

CREATE A NEAR WALLET

Use **Meteor Wallet** at **meteorwallet.app**, about a minute:

1	2	3	4	5
Open Wallet	Create a password	Claim your .near name	Create Wallet	Save your seed phrase

Why: the submission form asks for a mainnet NEAR payout account. You need it to submit and to receive funds. Never share your seed phrase.



WATCH: WALLET CREATION TUTORIAL

youtube.com/watch?v=XbmbjgedQV8

STEP 3 OF 4 · CREDITS

CLAIM $10 IN AI CREDITS

Go to **nearbuilders.org/dashboard**. One NEAR AI Cloud API key per builder; the offer closes 11/15/2026.

1. **Connect with NEAR**
2. **Sign the message**
3. **Publish a builder profile**
4. **Claim $10.00**
5. **Copy your key**

⚠ Your key starts with **sk-** and shows **once**. Never show it on screen, paste it into a chat or commit it.



WATCH: CLAIM AI CREDITS

youtube.com/watch?v=dACSz1mihRE

STEP 4 OF 4 · CONNECT YOUR AGENT

POINT YOUR AGENT AT NEAR

FASTEST: OPENCODE

1. Install OpenCode
2. Run **connect**
3. Search “Near AI cloud”
4. Paste your key
5. Pick a Confidential TEE model



WATCH: NEAR DEVHUB, 3 MIN

youtube.com/watch?v=WV1Jln57uCc

ANY OPENAI-COMPATIBLE CLIENT

```
base URL
https://cloud-api.near.ai/v1
model
z-ai/glm-5.3-flash
```

Cursor, Continue, Cline, Aider, Zed, Goose, LiteLLM… Hermes on NEAR: ICM starter guide, page 4.

Live model list: curl https://cloud-api.near.ai/v1/models (checked Nov 10)

PRIVATE MEANS CONFIDENTIAL TEE

PICK THE RIGHT PRIVACY TIER

Tier	Runs where	Private?
Confidential TEE	NEAR's own GPUs	**Yes.** Prompt and output hidden from everyone, NEAR included
Attested 3P	A third-party TEE	Encrypted path; the provider publishes its own proof
Incognito	The provider's servers	**No.** Only the gateway is in a TEE

Only the model call is private. Your laptop, your agent and the files it sends sit outside the TEE.

MODELS & PRICES

near.ai/models

Incognito = Anthropic, OpenAI, Google, xAI and others through NEAR's gateway

Quick start

GETTING HELP · ALL DAY

FIVE WAYS TO GET UNSTUCK

- **NEAR Builders Telegram:** ask in @nearbuilderschat (make a Telegram account first)
- **Builders Cafe WhatsApp:** drop your question in the chat
- **Grab one of us:** we’re walking around the room all day
- **Ask your favorite AI:** paste the error and ask it to explain (never your API key)
- **Ask each other:** the person next to you may have just solved it

DEMOS · 4:30–5:30

SIGN UP TO DEMO

2:30 sign-up opens: link posted in the WhatsApp

4:00 sign-up closes

4:15 running order on screen

4:30 local code freeze, demos start

SLOTS, FIRST COME, FIRST SERVED

Teams signed up	Each demo
10 or fewer	5 min
11 to 18	3 min
More than 18	First 18 demo, 3 min

A showcase, not a contest: no judging, no awards. The global deadline is still Nov 14.

SUBMITTING · BY SAT NOV 14, 6:59 PM ET

SUBMIT TO THE GLOBAL HACKATHON

1. Build it (code since the announcement counts)
2. Publish a **public** repository
3. Post a demo on X: built at NEAR HACKATHON, tag **@buidlcity**, **@NEARProtocol** and **@nearlegion** plus #NEARHackathon, with a video or screenshots
4. Submit the repo link and the X post link

The form asks for your mainnet NEAR payout account. One submission per project.

SUBMISSION FORM

nearhackathon.com/#apply

SHORTCUT

Hand HACKATHON.md to your agent

It knows the tracks, dates and submission steps. You choose the tracks, review the payload and confirm before it submits.

nearhackathon.com/HACKATHON.md

THE DAY'S RULES

FOUR RULES FOR TODAY

1 **Never show your API key** on screen, in a chat or in a repo.

2 **Build with your own favorite AI tools.** Save your $10 in NEAR credits for your app's private model calls.

3 **Code freeze at 4:30** for the demos. Keep building after; submit by Nov 14.

4 **Teams of up to 4.** One submission per project; solo builders welcome.

STUCK?

WHERE TO GET HELP

The hackpack

Pinned in the Builders Cafe WhatsApp

@nearbuilderschat

NEAR Builders Telegram. Make a Telegram account first

Grab one of us

We’re walking around all day. Or ask the person next to you

UP NEXT · 10:10

TECHNICAL TALKS

Time	Talk	Speaker
10:10	1 · Confidential Computing	Navneet Shrivastava
10:30	2 · Privacy, Data Security, Ownership & Sharing	Benjamin Rutan, Scro
10:50	3 · Build with ICM	Tony Singh
11:10	4 · Agentic Commerce	Sathya Krishnasamy
11:30	Idea worksheet, mixer, then build	Back of your agenda

SECTION 03 · 5:30

CLOSING & NETWORKING

Thank you for building with us today.

BEFORE SAT NOV 14, 6:59 PM ET

YOUR SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

- **Repo is public,** and the README says what it does and how to run it
- **Demo posted on X:** built at NEAR HACKATHON, tagging @buidlcity, @NEARProtocol, @nearlegion and #NEARHackathon
- **Form submitted** with your repo, your X post and your mainnet NEAR payout account
- **No API key** anywhere in the repo or the video

Tips for the demo post: nearhackathon.com/HACKATHON.md

STAY IN TOUCH

KEEP BUILDING WITH US

Join NEAR Legion · the NYC City Node

Follow @BuidlCity on X

nearbuilders.org · keep your builder profile

Builders Café · in person, every week

GROUP PHOTO NOW

BUILDERS CAFE WHATSAPP